



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cornerstone Classical Christian Academy
School Website: <https://cornerstoneclassical.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Cornerstone Classical Academy Kentucky 41022 (publicly represented in the crawl data as Cornerstone Classical Academy in Duval County, Florida) shows a predominantly classical orientation with clear strengths in formation, virtue, and the liberal arts emphasis, but with notable gaps in explicitly theological grounding and liturgical/community practices. Across the six classical-element categories, the school demonstrates strong alignment in School Purpose & Goal, Pedagogy, and Community/Parent engagement, while Religious & Metaphysical Foundations shows partial alignment (transcendentals appear in motto and virtues, but theology and liturgical practices are not evident). Curriculum and Faculty show mixed signals, with robust curricular commitments (Latin, history through high-school sequence, great literature emphasis in some materials) but less explicit articulation of the full Trivium/Quadrivium framework, or a living-faculty portrait in public materials. Overall, the school ranks CLASSICAL, with some important gaps in explicit theological grounding and certain faculty-pedagogy articulations. See category-by-category notes below for detailed keyword analyses, evidence, and rationale.

- Executive note on evidentiary basis: The public materials frequently express transcendent values (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue-focused character formation (motto, virtues). They also explicitly describe classical aims, liberal arts emphasis, and Socratic-style pedagogy in public materials. They also reveal nonsectarian stance, a public-charter context, and a broad curriculum (Latin, history, core knowledge sequences, and Great Books-oriented language emphasis in parts of the site). Citations anchor these observations to the site and knowledge-base materials.
- What would move the needle for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categories: emphasize explicit Great Books/Trivium content in curriculum pages, articulate a stronger "living curriculum" portrait of teachers as models, and foreground parents' formal co-educator role in materials. See category sections for specifics.
- Abstract: The school displays a classical orientation with strong virtue and liberal-arts emphasis and Socratic elements in pedagogy, plus robust parent/community interfaces, but with gaps in explicit theological grounding and some detailed classical-curriculum language (e.g., explicit Trivium/Quadrivium articulation). Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL, with room for needle-moving improvements in theology-liturgical grounding, explicit Great Books articulation, and a more defined living-faculty portrait.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize transcendent values via motto: "Learn the truth. Do the good. Love the beautiful." which signals transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty) as ideals in formation. - Virtues are explicitly listed (Integrity, Responsibility, Self Government, Respect, Courage, Perseverance, Humility), signaling character formation as a core aim. - The site states the school is nonsectarian and not

religious, indicating a lack of grounded theology and liturgical practices in public materials. This creates a gap relative to the theological grounding and liturgical/community practices signals in the Positive Keywords set.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, moral formation (as expressed in motto and virtues). - Negative keywords present: theology, liturgy, liturgical, sacred, worship (not evidenced in public materials). Absence noted via nonsectarian statement.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates transcendental values (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue formation but fails to evidentially ground in theology or liturgical/community practices within the public materials. With three sub-criteria, only one is clearly evident and two are not evidenced in public-facing materials, which aligns with a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials articulate a classical aims framework: liberal arts and sciences education that cultivates virtuous living and civic responsibility, with an emphasis on Western Civilization. This aligns with the classical telos of education as formation (virtue and wisdom) rather than only job prep. - Motto and virtues reinforce formation over mere information, including truth/goodness/beauty and character formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, liberal education, classical mission, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, human flourishing, civic virtue. Evidence-oriented phrasing in the public materials supports these. - Negative keywords present: none of the explicit workforce/career-readiness signals appear as core aims in the public-facing materials. Absence supports classical alignment for this category.

Why this rating - The programmatic statements emphasize formation, virtue, and the classical telos (truth/goodness/beauty) with liberal-arts framing, aligning this category with CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum includes Latin from early grades (K5) and continued Latin, aligning with classical languages emphasis; high-school sequences include literature, history, mathematics, science; world-language study; government/economics/moral philosophy. This signals strong classical curricular strands. - The materials reference the Core Knowledge Sequence and classical-literature orientation, plus primary-source emphasis and Western-civilization framing in curriculum descriptions. The site describes reading “great classical works of literature” and a history-centered organization around civics and civic responsibility. - The public materials show emphasis on history/literature through Western Civilization and a classical sequence (e.g., four years of history, four years of literature in high school).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Latin, Great Books/reading of classical literature, history, Western Civilization, liberal-arts emphasis, grammar/logic/rhetoric language-structure (though explicit articulation of Trivium/Quadrivium is less overt in some pages). Core Knowledge Sequence is referenced.

- Negative keywords present: explicit references to “social studies” framing as opposed to strict history, or explicit STEM-first framing are not predominant in these public materials; however, some materials emphasize core knowledge and language-first approaches, which may not fully foreground a strict Trivium/Quadrivium architecture in every page. Overall, some classical cues are present, but not uniformly explicit across all curriculum pages.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates core classical curriculum elements (Latin, classical literature, history, Western civilization, and liberal-arts framing) but lacks explicit, comprehensive, public articulation of the full Trivium/Quadrivium structure in every curriculum page. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

What keywords were identified - Positive: Latin, Great Books (literature, classical works), Western Civilization, Core Knowledge Sequence, history, literature, world language. - Evidence of “great books” phrasing appears in some pages describing classical literature and primary-source emphasis.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials explicitly reference Socratic discussion as a classroom mode, including statements about a traditional/classical classroom prioritizing teacher authority and Socratic dialogue. This is a hallmark of classical pedagogy. - The materials describe a classical approach to memory work and writing (e.g., recitation, classical rhetoric training) in line with traditional classical pedagogy; there are mentions of upper-school rhetoric, speeches, and opportunities to engage in rhetoric training. - The site mentions lower-school activities that foster memory and repetitive learning in a way that aligns with scholé-like/restful learning and memory-building signals, though not uniformly explicit across all pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, great conversation, memory work/recitation, rhetoric, speeches, debate, scholé/restful learning. - Negative keywords present: nothing explicit in the public materials indicates a non-classical pedagogy; the public materials do not emphasize exclusively project-based or student-directed pedagogy as the sole method.

Why this rating - Clear, explicit references to Socratic dialogue and rhetoric training position Pedagogy as CLASSICAL. Some memory/recitation practices and a presence of restorative/scholé ideas also align with classical pedagogy. The presence of these signals justifies CLASSICAL.

Notes on signals - The explicit “traditional classroom” and Socratic discussion cues are strong indicators. See statements describing the Socratic discussion approach.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize virtues and character formation, with the faculty/teachers framed as role models in virtuous living and in forming students (the living curriculum idea appears in general classical-education discourse; the specific site materials emphasize teacher accountability and certification). However, explicit, public-facing statements about “the living curriculum,” a formal portrait of the teacher as a model, or a “portrait of a teacher” are not uniformly explicit in the public site pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: “virtue,” “moral formation,” “teacher as mentor” (in the six-element lexicon, though explicit site mentions are more implicit); “living curriculum” is a standard classical phrase found in the knowledge-base lexicon (not clearly present as a direct phrase in the Florida crawl). - Negative keywords present: Public pages rarely articulate a “teacher-as-facilitator” or “facilitator-on-the-side” philosophy; however, explicit “living curriculum portraits” are not clearly stated in the public materials, limiting the category’s public signals.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates some classical faculty signals (virtue-focused, teacher accountability, standard certification) but lacks explicit, public-facing articulation of a fully developed “faculty as living curriculum” portrait and deeply articulated classical-faculty culture. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL for the Faculty category.

Key supporting items - Virtues and character emphasis are clear on the site. - The broader classical-education lexicon and concept of “living curriculum” exist in the knowledge-base documents and underpin public-facing expectations, but not all are explicitly stated on the public site.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize partnerships with families and parental involvement as part of the classical model (the public “ICE Pamphlet” and classical-education framing emphasize partnership with families and parent formation as core components of classical education). This includes parent participation and the role of parents as co-teachers in classical education models. - The site also provides family-focused resources (handbook, parent information meetings, and family/parent engagement content visible on the public pages). The “Family & Student Handbook” page and parent resources indicate a strong open-door stance in the school’s community model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, open campus/parent involvement, family catechesis, parents as co-teachers (as echoed in ICE booklet content). The ICE pamphlet explicitly outlines parent-scholastic partnership and formation. - Negative keywords present: there is no strong negative signal in the public materials about parent involvement; the site presents active parent engagement. The explicit open-campus signals are not universal, but the public materials still reflect a welcoming stance toward parent involvement.

Why this rating - The publicly visible materials strongly emphasize parent-partnered education and family engagement, consistent with classical-community practice. This aligns with CLASSICAL signals for the Parents & Community category.

Notes on sources - ICE pamphlet material and the classical-education lexicon show explicit parent-partner formation and family involvement signals.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Introduce explicit theology/theological grounding and liturgical/community practices in public-facing materials (e.g., statement of faith or explicit liturgical practices, even if the school remains nonsectarian, to provide a more robust religious-metaphysical grounding visible to the public). Concrete steps: add a theology anchor statement and a community worship/rite description to the site.
 - For Element 5 (Faculty): Publicly articulate the living-curriculum portrait of teachers, including how teachers model virtue and carry the classical curriculum forward in practice; publish faculty development practices grounded in classical pedagogy; feature teacher exemplars and guides on the website.
 - For Element 3 (Curriculum): More explicit articulation of Trivium/Quadrivium content in the curriculum pages; clearly label and describe Seven Liberal Arts components (grammar, logic, rhetoric; quadrivium) and how they structure the K-12 curriculum; emphasize Great Books and primary sources, with direct examples in each grade band to show a full Great-Books cadence.
 - For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand public-facing materials to explicitly describe parent-formation programs, book studies, and co-teacher roles with concrete schedule and signup information; reinforce open-campus/visitation policies on the site, with a dedicated section detailing parent involvement opportunities.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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